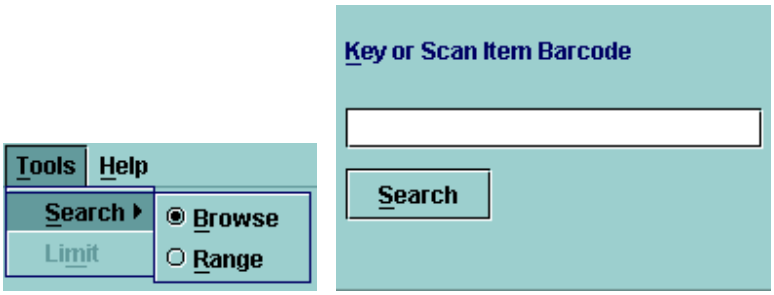
Searching for Records in a Remote Database

To search for records in a remote database, you must be authorized for function 199 (Allow Z39.50 searches). See Authorized Functions for more information.

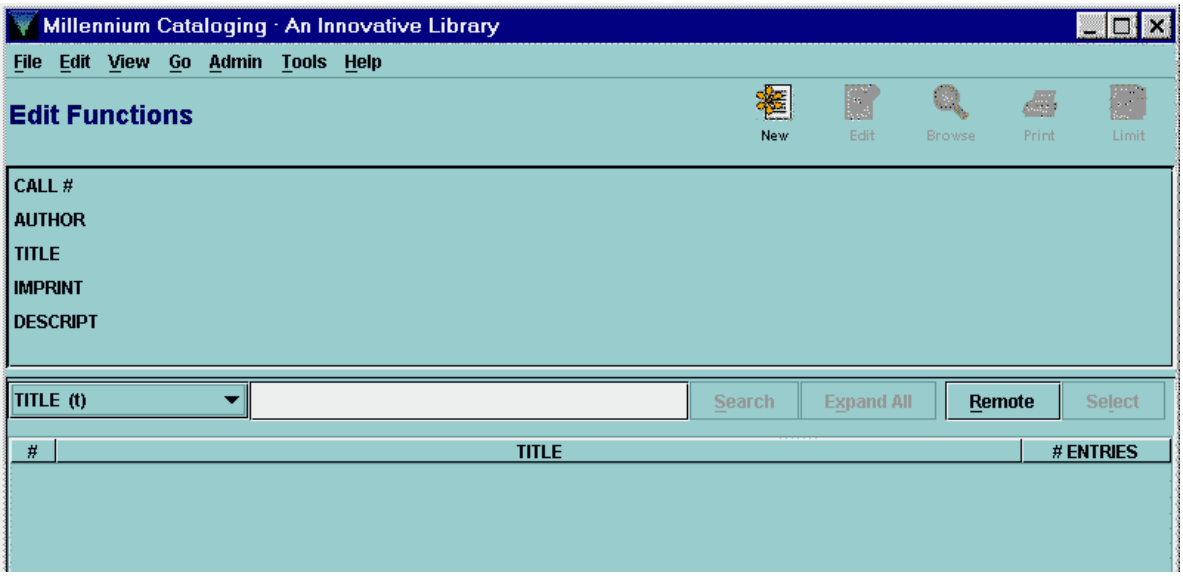
If your library has acquired the Z39.50 client program, you can use Millennium Acquisitions, Cataloging, ILL, and Serials to search remote databases. When you download records found in these remote searches, you can use them to overlay existing records in your database. For more information, see Overlaying an Existing Record with a New Record from a Remote Search.

To search for records in a remote database:

1. Choose Tools | Search | Browse or the Search button. Either the menu or the button will be available, depending on the Millennium application and mode.

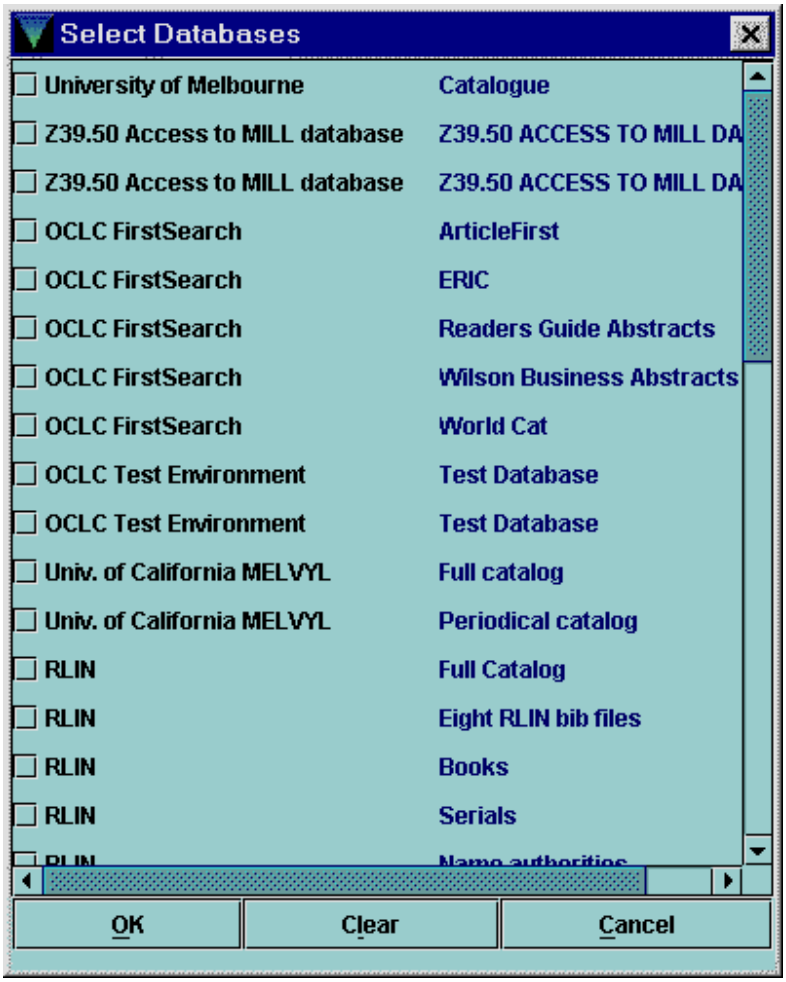


The Browse search screen appears:



2. Choose the Remote button.

   This opens the Select Databases dialog, which lists the servers to which your library has access:



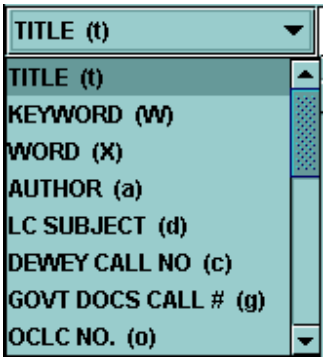
NOTE

The databases that appear in the dialog are controlled by the z39.50 servers file.

3. Select the check boxes for the databases that you want to search.

   Millennium remembers the databases you select for the current session. To clear your selections, choose the Clear button.

4. Choose OK to confirm your selections or Cancel. The Remote search screen appears.
5. Choose an index from the drop-down menu:



This is an example. Indexes are configurable. See Adding Search Options for a Database for more information.

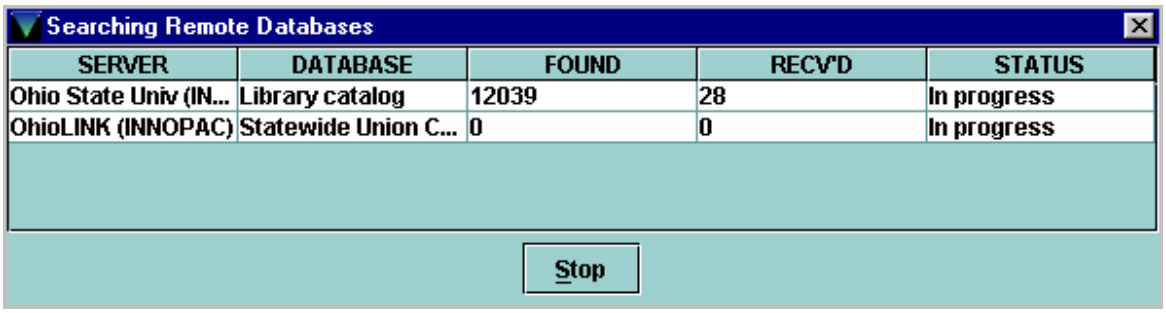
6. Enter the search criteria in the text box.

There is no need to enter an index tag (for example, t, w, or x) in the text box before entering the search criteria. An index has already been selected.



7. Choose Search.

The Searching Remote Databases dialog displays the status of the search against each selected remote database:

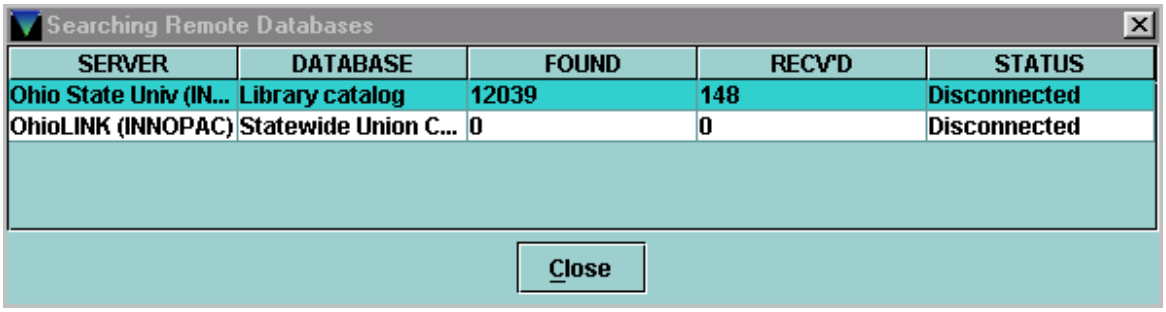


8. Let the search complete or choose Stop when a sufficient number of records have been found.

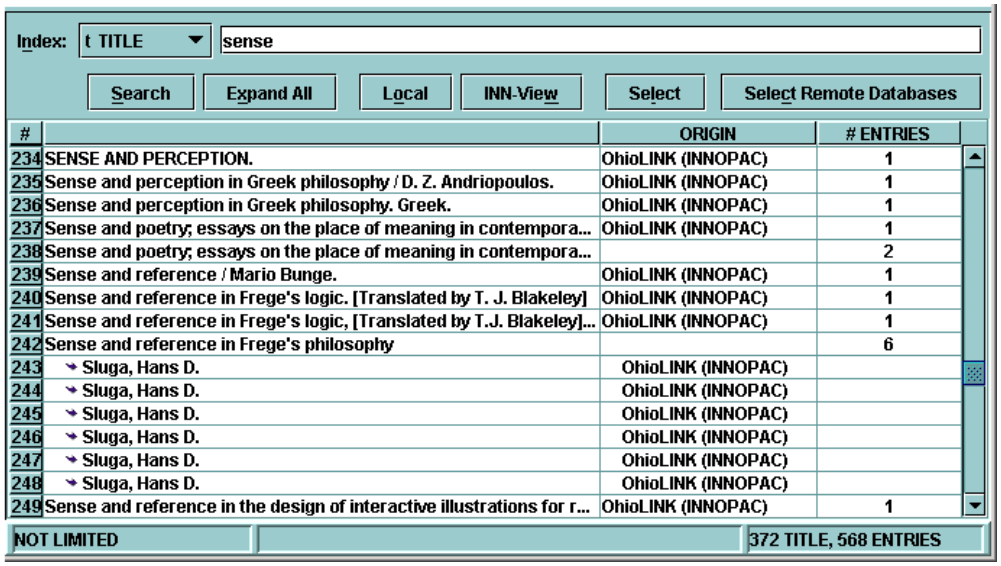
When the search completes, the dialog displays the number of records found for each database. The records are then transmitted to Millennium as indicated in the

Received column. These records do not exist in your database until you create mirror records.

9. Choose Close:



The records that were received are listed in a browse display:



The browse displays the authority record as well as the Origin for the record. When you open a record from this browse display, the originating database name displays in the title bar.